



Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Program functionalities are limitless!



Learning Outcome:

Understand key information about the concepts, principles, and methodologies in simple spoken and written situations. Talk about programming techniques, use cases, kinds, and sequences in simple spoken and written situations.

Ask your partner:

- Do you use computer programs?
Mention 5
- How does a computer work?

Can Do Statements:

- I can explain what a computer program is.
- I can talk about the usefulness of computer programs.
- I can describe key features related to computer programs.



Let's Explore!

David needs help with his computer program homework.



Instructions: Read the text below.

David: Hello, Laura. Did you finish the homework about computer programs?

Laura: Yes, You find a lot of information on the internet; that's why I always do my homework in the computer lab.

David: Cool! I don't understand anything about programs. Can you explain to me what they are?

Laura: Sure, a computer program is a set of instructions and rules that computers need for functioning. Programmers design programs for particular tasks; they use programming languages to create and configure programs.

David: I understand now, do you know what the usefulness of programs is?

Laura: Yes, without programs the computer cannot even run, so there are system programs that permit the machine to start; the machine executes those programs in the central processing unit. A computer program usually executes information with the help of an interpreter which is a platform that performs the instructions of each program.

David: Wow! And, how many programs are there?

Laura: Well, there are as many computer programs as you can imagine.

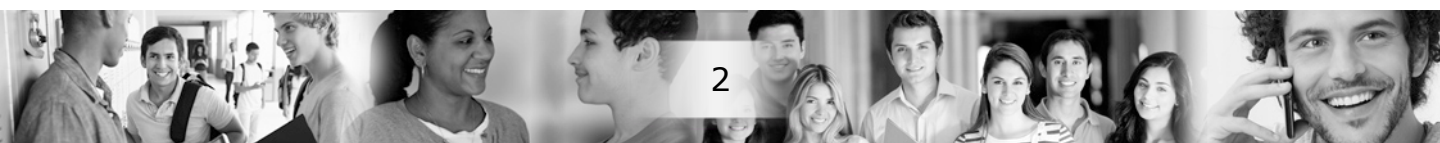
David: What are their features?

Laura: There are programs to perform any possible job! A programmer creates algorithms, which are the main structure of a program as they store its tasks and applications; besides, there are different programming languages for creating the algorithms, all those languages still evolve!

David: What is the difference between system and operational software?

Laura: Well, system software refers to the operating system that permits the software and hardware interaction and functionality; on the other hand, operating software consist of the programs we work with, not only on the pc, but also online.

David: Thanks, Laura.





Let's Practice!

Laura explains what a computer program is.

Instructions: Read the paragraph. Underline all the verbs in simple present.

1. A computer program is a set of rules and instructions.
2. When the user executes a program, the computer behaves in a certain way.
3. People use programs to perform different kinds of tasks.



Let's Practice!

Let's find the key features related to computer programs.

Instructions: Select the correct answer.

1. Which is a very important part of a program that contains the instructions of the tasks?
Hint: It's similar to code.
 - a. Algorithm
 - b. Applications
 - c. Software
 - d. The CPU
2. What is the name of the collection of computer programs?
Hint: Not the physical parts of the computer.
 - a. Hardware
 - b. Software
 - c. Codes
 - d. Algorithm
3. What are the functional categories of computer programs?
 - a. Application hardware
 - b. Operative system
 - c. Application software and system software
 - d. Operating system and application software





Extension Activity

It's your turn to find the most common computer programs used today.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Find information about the three most common computer programs people use.
- Find information about their characteristics.
- Write down your ideas, use the simple present, and there is/are.
- Share your ideas about computer programs.

Self-Assessment

- I deepen my knowledge on computer programs.
- I describe some characteristics of computer programs.
- I express ideas in a paragraph.
- I share the information with my partners.

Yes No

☐ ☐
☐ ☐
☐ ☐
☐ ☐


Target Words

- **execute** (verb): to complete or perform something
e.g. The machine executes those programs in the central processing unit.
- **application** (noun): program designed to fulfil a specific task
e.g. Algorithms are the main structure of a program as they store its tasks and applications.
- **feature** (noun): a typical quality or characteristic
e.g. What are their features?
- **set** (noun): group of elements
e.g. A computer program is a set of instructions and rules that computers need for functioning.
- **perform** (verb): to do something
e.g. There are programs to perform any possible job.
- **usefulness** (noun): similar to utility
e.g. Do you know what the usefulness of programs is?



Learning Points

The Simple Present Tense

There is one common tense in English you use to talk about the present in general, it's called simple present.

You can use the simple present when you talk about habits or routines, permanent situations, and scientific facts that have always the same result.

Example:

*I always **buy** Apple products.*

*She **designs** software for a big company.*

We usually use the **simple present** with frequency adverbs, because habits and routines imply frequency.

Example:

*I **usually write** a report every Monday.*

Notice how the verbs always keep their base form in interrogative and negative statements.

Example:

Does Mary **find** new errors in the software testing?

Notice that when we have affirmative statements, we add -s to the verbs in third person singular.

Examples:

She **designs** software for a big company.

He **sells** software.

There are certain rules for adding -s: When the verb ends in consonant + y: Eliminate -y and add -ies.

Example: He tries to design a new app.

When the verb ends in vowel + y, you only add -s.

Example:

*He **buys** the latest software.*

When verbs end in -sh, -ch, -z, -ss, -x : Add -es.

Example:

*He **fixes** his boss' computer.*

In the following chart, you can see the structure of the **present simple**.





Learning Points

Present Simple			
	Affirmative	Negative	Interrogative
I/you/we/they	I find a new program. You send an email.	We don't send new products.	Do they get products?
He/she/it	He sells software	She doesn't buy software.	Does she buy a computer?

Examples

- *I don't understand anything about programs.*
- *Do you know what the usefulness of programs is?*
- *System software refers to the operating system that permits the software and hardware interaction and functionality.*

There Is, There Are in Affirmative

You can use **there is** and **there are** to refer to the existence of things or people.
You use **there is** or the contraction **there's** for singular nouns

For example: There **is a** computer.
There's a technician.

You use **there are** or the contraction **there're** for plural nouns.

For example: There **are some computers**.
There 're two technicians.

Examples

- *Without programs the computer cannot even run, so there are system programs that permit the machine to start.*
- *How many programs are there?*
- *There are as many computer programs as you can imagine.*





Learning Points

Different Types of Computer Programs

There are two kinds of **programs in computing**: **application** programs, and **system** programs; the difference between those two types of programs is slight and has to do more with marketing matters than with functionality.

Application programs are the one we use to carry on our work and to fulfill our tasks; examples of applications **are game programs** and word processors among others.

System programs are the one in charge of **running the system**; they ensure the functionality of the **hardware** and **software** altogether; what is more, they provide the environment for the applications to run. This is, they facilitate the hardware and software resources an application needs to run. The most important system program is the **operating system** which permits the computer to work.